INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Marketing

MARKETING MANAGEMENT TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy.
2. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
3. Describe marketing functions and related activities.
4. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.
5. Identify company's brand promise.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the international brand manager and the market research manager for CRUNCHWELL SNACKS, a U.S. company that makes roasted chickpea snacks. The vice president of global marketing (judge) wants your team to recommend how CRUNCHWELL should introduce its snacks in Mexico, the company's first market outside the United States.

CRUNCHWELL's snacks come in six flavors, including Sea Salt, Ranch and Honey BBQ. A 5-ounce bag sells for $3.99 in U.S. grocery stores. The brand promise printed on every bag is "Real crunch. Real protein. Nothing fake." In the United States, CRUNCHWELL is positioned as a healthier swap for potato chips and appeals mostly to health-conscious adults ages 25–40. U.S. sales have grown 20% a year, but competition from larger snack companies is increasing.

Mexico is one of the largest snack markets in the world. Mexican shoppers buy many snacks from small neighborhood stores rather than large supermarkets, and spicy, lime and chili flavors are by far the most popular. Large snack brands already dominate those neighborhood stores. In 2020, Mexico began requiring black warning labels on the front of packaged foods that are high in calories, sugar, sodium or fat. Four of CRUNCHWELL's six flavors would need no warning labels, but Ranch and Honey BBQ would each need one for sodium.

The vice president of global marketing (judge) will present the expansion plan to the executive team next quarter. Specifically, the vice president (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain why expanding globally matters to CRUNCHWELL's future
- Describe how buying behavior in Mexico differs from the U.S. and what that means for CRUNCHWELL's products
- Recommend how CRUNCHWELL should position the brand in Mexico, and whether its brand promise should change
- Describe the marketing activities CRUNCHWELL must plan for the launch (product, price, distribution and promotion)

You will present your recommendations to the vice president of global marketing (judge) in a meeting to take place in the vice president's (judge's) office. The vice president (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your recommendations and have answered the vice president's (judge's) questions, the vice president (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Why expand to another country when our U.S. sales are still growing?
2. How do we get onto the shelves of small neighborhood stores where big brands already dominate?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Describe marketing functions and related activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify company's brand promise.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	